Land Your IB Coffee Chats with Claude Cowork

Two templates and seven prompts that turn alumni networking into a system. Fill in the blanks, paste into Cowork, and review every draft before it sends.

TEMPLATE

1. LinkedIn Connection Note

Get the accept first.

LinkedIn caps connection notes at 300 characters, so this is the short version. Save the full pitch for after they accept.

COPY & PERSONALIZE

Hi _____, I'm a freshman at the University of _____ in the _____ Investment Group and saw you're in *insert their group* at *insert their bank*. I'm starting to think about IB recruiting and would really value your perspective. Would love to connect!

TEMPLATE

2. Coffee Chat Outreach Message

Send this once they accept.

The full ask. Personalize the city, bank, and current role for every person.

COPY & PERSONALIZE

Hi _____,

My name is _____ and I'm a freshman at the University of _____ and a Senior Analyst in the _____ Investment Group. I've been thinking about how I want to approach the investment banking recruiting process and I would love to hear your advice. I've also always loved *insert their current city* and hope to end up there after banking, so I'd be curious to hear about your perspective on that market.

If you're free sometime in the next couple weeks, I'd love to send over a few times to connect and chat about your experience at *insert their investment bank*, your time in PE, and how you made the most of your time at the University of _____.

Best,

_____

SETUP

3. Build Your Tracker

Run this once at the start.

Gives Cowork your background and a spreadsheet to track every contact.

PASTE INTO COWORK

I'm a freshman at the University of _____ recruiting for investment banking. I'm a Senior Analyst in the _____ Investment Group, I'm from _____, and I'm interested in _____ (e.g., TMT, healthcare). I'd like to end up in _____ long term.

Create a spreadsheet called "IB Networking Tracker" in my working folder with these columns: Name, Bank, Group, Title, Location, LinkedIn URL, Class Year, Shared Connections/Interests, Status (Not Contacted / Request Sent / Connected / Chat Scheduled / Chat Done / Thanked / Referral Asked), Date of Last Contact, Notes.

Save my two templates (pasted below) as a file called templates.md so you can reference them later.

paste Templates 1 and 2

SOURCING

4. Find Alumni at Your Target Bank

Build the list before you write a word.

PASTE INTO COWORK

Open LinkedIn in Chrome and go to _____'s company page. Click the People tab and filter by school: University of _____. For anyone currently in investment banking, or who was previously in IB at _____ and has since moved to PE or another buy-side role, add them to my tracker with their name, current title, group, location, LinkedIn URL, and graduation year.

Prioritize analysts and associates who graduated within the last 5 years. Don't send any connection requests. Just build the list and show me the top 15 when you're done.

OUTREACH

5. Personalized Connection Requests

Specific beats generic every time.

PASTE INTO COWORK

For each person in my tracker with status "Not Contacted" at _____, open their LinkedIn profile and look for anything we have in common: hometown, high school, club, major, sport, fraternity/sorority, or industry interest.

Draft a personalized connection note for each using Template 1 in templates.md. Work in the most specific thing we have in common and mention their group by name. Every note must stay under 300 characters. Put the drafts in a new column called "Draft Note" and show me all of them for review. Don't send anything until I approve.

SCHEDULING

6. Follow-Up + Calendar Times

Turn the accept into a call.

PASTE INTO COWORK

Check my LinkedIn invitations and messages for anyone in my tracker who has accepted my connection request. For each new connection, draft a follow-up using Template 2 in templates.md. Fill in their current city, their bank, and their current role, and adjust the "your time in PE" line to match what they actually do.

Then check my Google Calendar for the next two weeks and find three 30-minute windows between _____ and _____ on weekdays that don't conflict with anything. Add those times, in the contact's time zone, as a closing line in each draft. Show me the drafts before sending, then update their status to "Connected."

PREP

7. Pre-Call Prep Sheet

Walk in knowing more than they expect.

PASTE INTO COWORK

I have a coffee chat with _____ from _____ on _____. Build me a one-page prep sheet with:

(1) Their background: education, career path, current group and role, and how long they've been there, pulled from their LinkedIn. (2) Recent deals or news involving their bank's group from the last 6 months. (3) What we have in common. (4) 8 to 10 thoughtful questions tailored to them, covering their path into banking, what their group does day to day, how they prepared for recruiting as an underclassman, what they'd do differently, their view on their city as a market, and how they made the jump to PE or their current role if relevant. (5) A 30-second "tell me about yourself" I can use, based on my background.

Save it as a PDF in my working folder named "_____ Prep Sheet."

REFERRALS

8. Thank-You Note + Referral Ask

One chat should lead to the next.

PASTE INTO COWORK

I just finished my call with _____. Here are my notes: *paste quick notes on what you talked about and any advice they gave*

Draft two messages: (1) A thank-you note to send tonight. Keep it short, reference one or two specific things they said, and mention how I'm going to act on their advice. (2) A follow-up to send in about a week asking if there's anyone else at their firm, ideally in a group they mentioned or other alumni from my school, they'd be comfortable introducing me to. Make it easy for them to say yes and include a short 2 to 3 sentence blurb about me they can forward.

Update their status in my tracker to "Chat Done," log the date, and add my notes to their row. Set a reminder on my calendar to send message #2 next week.

BONUS

9. Weekly Check-In

Nobody falls through the cracks.

Run every Sunday. Always review drafts before anything sends; LinkedIn restricts automated activity, so Cowork drafts and you click send.

> **PASTE INTO COWORK**
>
> Look at my IB Networking Tracker and give me a summary: how many people are at each status, who accepted but hasn't gotten a follow-up, who I chatted with but haven't thanked, and anyone I haven't heard back from in 10+ days who's worth a polite nudge. Draft the nudges for me to review.

Schedule a Call Directly with Chase to Learn about 1-on-1 Mentorship: wallstalpha.com/apply